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AMD A8-3850 or i5-2500k?

I'm 17 years old and need some help updating my old PC. I have all the basic components and want to update my motherboard, processor, graphics card and RAM. I want to keep the cost low. The PC will be mostly used for gaming so it should be capable of playing all the games. There's no need for higher FPS in games as I don't have the budget to buy an expensive graphics card. Please give me product names along with their prices. And is AMD A8-3850 or i5-2500k better?

Syed Arfad

Looking at your requirement – moderate gaming and regular tasks – we advise you to go for the AMD system as the Intel Core i5-2500K will require a budget in excess of ₹25,000. With an AMD Llano processor, you can buy a cheaper graphics card and then use the combined power of the integrated graphics and the discrete card we're suggesting.

- **Processor:** AMD A8-3850 – ₹7,000
- **Motherboard:** Gigabyte A75M-UD2H ₹6,500
- **Graphics card:** XFX HD 6670 – ₹5,500
- **RAM:** Corsair Vengeance 4GB DDR3 RAM – ₹2,500

Laptop for ethical hacking

I have a ₹35,000-45,000 budget and am confused whether to buy Dell or Lenovo (preferably Dell 14r and 15r or Lenovo IdeaPad Z series). I've heard that Lenovo has good accessories bundled but Dell's servicing is better than Lenovo's.

Following are my requirements:

- **RAM:** 4 GB
- **Processor:** 2nd gen i5 2430 or 2nd gen i5 2410
- **Graphics card:** For Dell – AMD Radeon HD 6470m or NVIDIA GT 525M; For Lenovo – NVIDIA n12p gv1 or NVIDIA GeForce GT 520M
- **Screen size, battery life, HDD size and style:** Doesn't matter

I'm a Computer Science student, average gamer (*NFS*, *StarCraft 2*, etc) and will use multiple OSes to learn ethical hacking.

Please suggest similar configurations from other brands available for cheaper.

Joseph Jayadev

For your needs, buy the Acer Aspire 5830TG Timeline X laptop. It has a 15-inch screen, comes with a Core i5-2410M processor, oodles of RAM and HDD space, and NVIDIA GeForce graphics with enough gaming chops for casual gaming. It fits very well into your budget. Read the full review here (<http://goo.gl/ipvQf>). If you can't lay your hands on the Aspire 5830TG, I recommend the Dell Inspiron 15R as it allows you to pick and choose the components online – I can't say about an exact model with a specific configuration because Dell keeps changing it on their web site (www.dell.co.in/laptops). But seriously, the choice is yours.



Acer Timeline 5830

Also you might want to keep an eye on the "Top 10 Laptops" section on thinkdigit.com.

Building a rig for under 35k

I wanted to build my rig. Following is the config I've decided upon:

- **Processor:** Intel Core i5 2500K – ₹10,300
- **Motherboard:** ASUS P8Z68 V – ₹11,800
- **HDD:** Seagate 500GB 200 RPM – ₹1,700
- **Memory:** GSkill 2x4GB 1600 MHz – ₹3,000
- **Cabinet:** Cooler Master AF 922 – ₹6,700
- **PSU:** Corsair TX650 – ₹5,400

The total amount comes up to ₹38,900. I would like to bring this amount to under 35K, without affecting performance much. What do you suggest I change? Also, let me know where I should buy these from.

Harsh Kotak

Looking at your rig and the absence of a dedicated graphics card, you don't need such a high-end power supply unit or cabinet. So you can get more economical parts such as: Corsair 500W CX PSU for ₹3,200 or the

Cooler Master CM Elite 311 for ₹1,900 (if you want a vanilla cabinet with no frills) or NZXT Crafted Series Guardian 921 RB for ₹4,000 (attractive looking cabinet)

This will cut down your pricing from ₹12,100 (for the PSU and cabinet you've chosen) to ₹5,100 (if you go with CM ELite 311) or ₹7,200 (if you go with NZXT cabinet) getting your budget under ₹35,000. But note that you've not added a graphics card or a monitor in the rig, so that will take your price up further.

There are online resources from where you can get them such as primeabgb.com or smcinternational.in if you're not getting great prices at your local components store.

Graphics card for gaming

I have a Dell Inspiron 530s (slim). I need a decent graphics card that can support games such as *Assassin's Creed: Brotherhood*, *Grand Theft Auto IV* etc.

My configuration:

- **Processor:** Intel Pentium e5200 dual core @ 2.50 GHz
- **Motherboard:** Dell Ory007
- **Graphic chipset:** p35/g33/g31
- **RAM:** 2GB ddr2

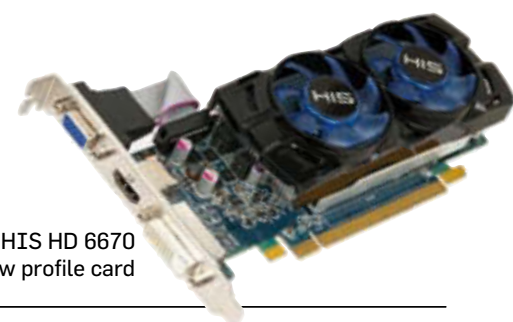
The problem is that the cabinet being slim, only low profile GPUs will work.

The ones I've shortlisted are: ATI Radeon HD 4650, Zotac GT520 PCI Express x1 and Sapphire HD 6450. My budget would be ₹5,000. Please give more suggestions and recommend the best solution.

Varun Shijo

The GT series of cards is not meant for gaming. In fact, any low power GPU for that matter is not good for gaming. They're ideal for HD content, and not much else.

If you're serious about gaming, the least you should look for is HD 6670 and above. HIS Low-Profile HD 6670 is a half-height form factor card, but you'll need to check for its availability in your locality.



HIS HD 6670 low profile card